Unit 11 — Debate and Discussion

Track E · Klasse 9 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can present a 90-second argument for or against a motion.*
- *I can use 6 debate signposts (*I'd like to argue, my opponent claims, however, in response, finally, to summarise*).*
- *I can listen and respond to one specific point in a peer's argument.*

Lead-in I

Mr. Yilmaz proposed a class debate. The motion: *This class would replace one written test per term with a project-based assessment.* Naima leads the *for*. Eli leads the *against*. Mr. Yilmaz, who secretly favours both options, is moderator.

Vocabulary I

- motion
- proposition
- opposition
- moderator
- point of order
- rebut
- concede
- argument
- evidence
- anecdote
- summary

Reading I

Debate vocabulary
motion, proposition, opposition, moderator, point of order, rebut, concede, argument, evidence, anecdote, summary.

Debate signposts
Opening: *I'd like to argue / I would like to speak in favour / against …* **Listing:** *Firstly … Secondly … Lastly …* **Counter:** *My opponent claims … / However, … / In response, …* **Concession:** *I accept that … but …* **Closing:** *Finally / To summarise / In short, I would urge you to support / oppose this motion.*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Choose: *opening / counter / closing*: ”I’d like to argue …” → ___ ; ”My opponent claims …” → ___ ; ”To summarise …” → ___ .
2. Match: rebut → counter; concede → accept partly. (T / F)

Niveau E — productive

3. Build a 4-sentence opening for or against the motion using 3 signposts.

Your turn I

Class debate. Two teams of 4 + 1 moderator. Each speaker delivers a 90-second argument with 4 signposts. Listening team prepares one specific rebuttal per speaker. The moderator times strictly.

Sample

I'd like to speak in favour of the motion. Firstly, project-based assessment captures skills that a written test cannot — research, design, presentation. Secondly, project-based work tends to involve real audiences, which makes the writing better. My opponent will claim that projects can be unfair across groups. I accept that, but it can be controlled with clear rubrics. Finally, replacing one test per term is moderate. To summarise: a small change, a real benefit. I urge you to

Your turn II

support the motion.

Reflect I

- I can present a 90-second argument with 4 signposts.
- I can rebut one specific point.
- I can concede one point gracefully.

Further reading / listening I

- ESU (English-Speaking Union) — student debate clips.
- BBC Sounds — *Question Time* extracts.